Ambitious targets

After four years of negotiations, in December 2022, representatives from 192 countries signed the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (GBF). The most far-reaching international agreement on biodiversity yet, this framework agreed on key targets for 2030. The most important of these were: to restore 30 percent of all degraded terrestrial, freshwater, and marine ecosystems; to conserve 30 percent of Earth's surface; to halt species extinction, protect genetic diversity, and manage human-wildlife conflicts; and to reduce the introduction of invasive alien species by 50 percent.

While agreeing on targets is crucial, coming to a consensus on how to implement them is equally vital, and in this respect the GBF marked an important step forward, pledging to integrate biodiversity into government decision-making, provide help for poorer nations and Indigenous peoples, and mobilize US$200 billion annually to finance these targets.

"If we care about our common future … we should all in part be naturalists."

Partha Dasgupta

See also: Human activity and biodiversity • The economic impact of climate change • Harnessing artificial intelligence • Developing nature-based solutions • Nature's contributions to people